

ISSUE 56

AUGUST 30, 2026



Happy August 30 Victory Day!

LAST WEEK IN TÜRKİYE

A weekly roundup of the top news
and developments in Türkiye



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REMINDERS BY NUMBERS



529 DAYS

since Ekrem Imamoglu was arrested.
The indictment seeks up to 2,430 years
in prison



58 DAYS

since comedian Deniz Göktaş was
arrested. He remains in prison
awaiting trial over charges related to
his stand-up show. Released and
arrested again



46 DAYS

since Nasuh Mahruki, AKUT
rescue group founder, jailed in
pretrial detention on charges of
“inciting the public to hatred and
hostility on a post on X.



30 DAYS

since elected Üsküdar Mayor Sinem
Dedetaş was jailed pending trial,
despite not being convicted of any
crime.



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PRESS GROUPS: “BANNING AN UNPUBLISHED BOOK IS CENSORSHIP.”

Five Turkish publishing and journalism organizations condemned the ban on “Millet Şahidimdir,” a book compiling detained Istanbul Mayor Ekrem İmamoğlu’s defenses, arguing that blocking it before publication is an intervention in publishing and the public’s right to information. They said the ban amounts to prior censorship and violates constitutional and international protections for freedom of expression and the press, pledging to continue opposing such restrictions.



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BBC NEWS TRKE

ECHR RULING ON KAVALA: “HE MUST BE RELEASED AS SOON AS POSSIBLE”

The European Court of Human Rights (ECHR) ruled that Trkiye violated six human-rights provisions in Osman Kavala’s case and said he must be released as soon as possible. Trkiye must also pay €113,342 in compensation and costs, while the ruling is legally binding and will be monitored by the Council of Europe.





DENİZ GÖKTAŞ: “A NEW ACCUSATION COMES UP EVERY TWO MONTHS”

Comedian Deniz Göktaş, who has been held in prison for nearly two months without an indictment, was first ordered released but then rearrested over a joke about the Daltonlar crime group, on allegations of “praising a crime and a criminal.” He said new charges seem to emerge every two months over jokes from his stand-up show and that he remains in good health and spirits.



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FOÇA LABOR GROUPS CALL FOR RELEASE OF ARRESTED MINERS' UNION ACTIVISTS

Workers from Doruk Madencilik and Eti Gümüş won payment of their unpaid wages after protesting in Ankara, but Bağımsız Maden-İş union leaders Gökay Çakır and Başaran Aksu were subsequently arrested. Labor and democracy groups in Foça protested the arrests, accusing authorities of siding with mining companies and demanding the union activists' immediate release.



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ANKA

INVESTIGATION INTO ALLEGED OVERSEAS MONEY TRANSFERS BY MELİH GÖKÇEK

Ankara prosecutors have launched an investigation into former Ankara Mayor Melih Gökçek over allegations that undocumented funds were transferred to companies abroad. The investigation was launched following a criminal complaint filed by journalist Mehmet Ağirel.





NEBATI'S GLITTER CAME AT THE PEOPLE'S EXPENSE

Former Treasury and Finance Minister Nureddin Nebati's economic policies, dubbed his glitter, hit ordinary people hard, while the Currency-Protected Deposit Scheme (KKM) transferred wealth from lower-income groups to the wealthy. The policy ultimately cost the state around \$60 billion, with the government now acknowledging the damage caused by its economic decisions.



OPERATION TARGETING THE SÜLEYMANCILAR

Ankara prosecutors said 35 people were arrested in an operation targeting an alleged organized crime group linked to Alihan Kuriş, while two others were placed under judicial control. All 37 suspects had been referred to a criminal judgeship with a request for their arrest following the August 25 operation.





THE PRESIDENTIAL PALACE CONTRACTOR WILL BUILD A STADIUM

Rönesans Holding's construction subsidiary REC International Construction won a ₺5.8 billion (\$130 million) contract to build a stadium, indoor sports hall, and Olympic-size swimming pool in Erzurum. The tender was conducted through a negotiated procedure, a method critics describe as a tailor-made process. Rönesans is known for major government projects including the Presidential Palace and several city hospitals.



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